D.J. PARIS

YOU DIDN'T WIN THAT LISTING. YOU BOUGHT IT.

The agent who quoted the highest number isn't doing the seller a favor.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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THREE AGENTS PITCH A SELLER. THE ONE WHO QUOTES HIGHEST GETS THE LISTING, THEN THE BLAME.

Thirty days later, the price-cut conversation starts.

03 / 05

THE REAL COST ISN'T THE NUMBER. IT'S HOW LONG IT SITS.

Realtor.com's own research found that homes closing around the four-week mark sell for 1.8 percentage points above the monthly average for comparable homes. Homes still sitting at eighteen weeks close 1.3 points below that average, a swing of more than three points either way. An inflated price doesn't win the seller a better number. It buys a longer sit, and the longer sit is what drags the final price down.

SAY THIS AT THE LISTING APPOINTMENT INSTEAD:

1 **Price to the comps, out loud.**
Give the honest number before you ever hear a competing one.

2 **If they want to test high, put it in writing.**
A reduction schedule, in the listing agreement, on day one.

3 **Name the deadline before you sign.**
"If we have no offer by this date, the price drops to this number."

4 **Walk from a listing you can't price honestly.**
A fast, well-priced listing beats a stale, inflated one every time.

THE TAKEAWAY

A HIGH NUMBER ISN'T A WIN. IT'S A LOAN AGAINST THE CLOSING PRICE.

Price it honestly, or put the cut in writing before you sign.

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